



The Granite 4 Nano family includes four instruct models and their base versions, ranging from 1.5 billion to 350 million parameters. Models such as Granite 4.0 H 1B and Granite 4.0 H 350M feature a hybrid transformer and Mamba architecture, combining

Mamba's hardware efficiency with transformer-based contextual understanding for optimal performance on constrained devices.

Performance benchmarks show Granite 4.0 H 1B leading in instruction-following and function-calling tasks, achieving 78.5 on IFEval and 54.8 on Berkeley's Function Calling Leaderboard v3.

This release strengthens IBM's AI portfolio with energy-efficient, edge-ready, and privacy-respecting models, reflecting a decisive move towards decentralised AI computing.

'Keep Android Open' movement challenges Google's developer verification policy

Google's plan to make developer verification mandatory for all apps installed on certified Android devices, including sideloaded ones, has triggered a major backlash across the open source community. The policy, set to be rolled out in March 2026 and enforced by September 2026 in Brazil, Indonesia, Singapore, and Thailand, extends Google's existing Play Store verification to all app installations, consolidating its control over 95 per cent of Android-certified devices worldwide.



The 'Keep Android Open' movement, led by software developer and F-Droid board member Marc Prud'hommeaux, has launched a global petition and open letter urging regulators to examine the antitrust implications

of Google's verification scheme. "I am sort of overwhelmed with the amount of support," Prud'hommeaux told *The Register*. "I would ballpark estimate that over 90–95 percent of people are somewhere between concerned and outraged, but pretty much everyone is against it."

The open letter warns that Google's mandate "represents an unprecedented expansion of Google's control over the Android ecosystem that threatens innovation, competition, privacy, and user freedom." The verification process requires developers to pay a \$25 fee, submit government ID, verify signing keys, and accept Google's terms.

Prud'hommeaux argues the move undermines open source independence and calls the policy "an existential threat to free software distribution platforms like F-Droid." He also challenges Google's claim that sideloading poses greater malware risks, noting that "77 malicious apps" were recently found on Google Play.

Regulators in Brazil, four US states, and the European Union are reportedly reviewing Google's plans as pressure mounts to keep Android open.

Ola Electric open sources its EV service infrastructure

Ola Electric Mobility Ltd has scaled up its 'Hyperservice' initiative to open source its proprietary service infrastructure and technology, marking a pivotal step towards decentralised and transparent electric vehicle maintenance in India.

Grafana Labs launches Mimir 3.0 to strengthen Prometheus-compatible monitoring in large enterprises

Grafana Labs has introduced Grafana Mimir 3.0 at KubeCon + CloudNativeCon North America 2025, marking a major architectural evolution of its open source, horizontally scalable metrics backend. The release positions Mimir 3.0 as a high-reliability, high-performance, and cost-efficient backbone for Prometheus-compatible monitoring in large enterprise environments.

Alongside Mimir 3.0, the company has introduced Grafana Tempo 2.9 with AI-assisted tracing, continued Kubernetes Monitoring enhancements including fleet management and Helm Chart v2, and deeper integrations with Prometheus and OpenTelemetry to simplify observability operations.

"From open source and open standards to open ecosystems and open minds – building in the open is core to our philosophy at Grafana Labs," said Myrle Krantz, senior director of engineering, Grafana Labs. "That's why we're continuing to invest in open source, like adding AI-assisted tracing in Tempo and making it easier to get the most out of OpenTelemetry and Prometheus. We're continuously improving Kubernetes Monitoring. And with the new Mimir 3.0 release, we're helping teams scale even more reliably, expanding what's possible for open observability in 2026 and beyond."

Mimir 3.0 is available via Grafana Cloud and self-managed open source deployments.



Image Source: <https://grafana.com/blog/2025/>